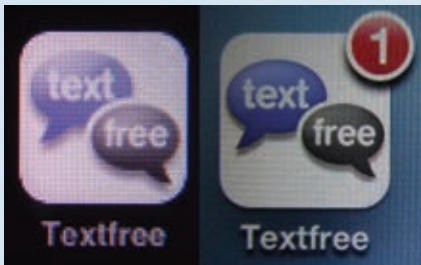


Smartphone displays of the world!

When Steve Jobs unveiled the iPhone 4, he said its display is unlike anything we have seen before. Thanks to Retina Display which gives it a 'magical' resolution it's something your eyes wouldn't catch. Okay we believe you Jobs, but what exactly is Retina Display? Is it just another marketing buzzword? Like Gorilla Glass or for that matter an IPS Panel? Are these really breakthrough technologies or just gimmick? Let's find out.

Retina Display – It's a screen and that's enough to it! Anyway at 326 dpi resolution it's one of the sharpest and slickest screens around. Human eye can distinguish dpi resolution only up to 300 when



Comparison between the screen resolutions of an iPhone 4 and iPhone 3

the device is held 10-12 inches away from it. The iPhone 4 screen provides 326 pixels (and that's our magical number) This is super high pixel resolution of 960x640 packed in a 3.5 inch screen. These pixels are squeezed between two glossy aluminosilicate glass which is used in helicopter and high speed train wind-shields.

Gorilla Glass – The much talked about Gorilla glass is a super strong, scratch



Retina Display better than Super AMOLED? We don't think so...



resistant display which is used in more than 100 products across 19 brands (as boasted by Corning the company behind Gorilla glass) One would practically require Thor's hammer to break this thing! Well not actually though as we've all seen Droid's with a huge crack on their screens.

Super AMOLED – An enhanced version of the AMOLED display Super AMOLED gives you better colour reproduction and brighter, sharper images. This is possible because the touch sensors are built on the display itself where as on a capacitive screen these sensors are placed in a separate layer. This makes the Super AMOLED one of the thinnest displays around.

IPS Panel – Expensive than a regular TFT-display the IPS panel provides wider viewing angle and consumes much less battery. In-Plane-Switching is apt for playing games and watching HD videos and that is why a lot of the newer phone models opt for this display. Apple uses IPS panel for the iPhone 4.

Future of smartphone displays

Quantum Dot display – new opponent for the current crop of smartphone displays is on the rise. This new display essentially uses semi-conducting crystals which measure of a billionth of a metre across. This helps in emitting light at an ultra narrow wavelength. Although still under development, let's hope to see this technology in iPhone 5 or in other phone models running Android 4.

Features you should understand before buying a headphone

Noise Cancelling headphones

– These type of headphones cancel the ambient noise and create antinnoise at your ear. This helps in lowering down



background dins coming from trains and buses. However they are not made to eliminate noise entirely.

Noise isolating headphones – Mostly used as recording monitors noise isolating headphones are effective in blocking out the background noise. They perform better than a noise cancelling headphone in secluding external sounds.

Surround headphones – Popular among gamers and home theatre fans this type of headphones create a bigger stereo sound experience by electronically enhancing the the surround effects. This gives the listener a feeling of more spacious sound than conventional headphones.

Demystifying common file extensions

FLAC – (Free lossless audio codec) This audio codec sounds better than an MP3 as it is lossless which means that every single bit of data can be recovered when the file is uncompressed, resulting in better quality audio experience.



ODT – Open Document Format is increasingly getting popular these days. File extension ODT gets suffixed by Tif it's a text file, ODS for a spreadsheet and similarly ODP for presentation file.

OGG – This codec can be used for audio, video, texts (subtitles) files. As it's an open source format it's free from any software patents and can be manipulated to suit any multimedia needs.